Encouraging students to seek help

Is help-seeking normal and visible?

EQUITY / TEACHING

ONE-PAGE TEACHING GUIDE

WHAT IS IT?

A culture of help-seeking is actively cultivated and normalised, with academic and wellbeing support promoted throughout the semester

WHY DOES IT MATTER?

The same course requirement can land very differently depending on time, money, care, disability, work, housing or confidence. Equity asks whether students with different lives have a real opportunity to participate and succeed, rather than simply receiving the same rule.

THE STUDENT EXPERIENCE

- “This course assumes university is the only thing happening in my life.”
- “I can technically enrol, but the way this is organised makes participation fragile.”

HOW CAN I DO IT?

- Explain where students can go for help and why using support is normal.
- Repeat support pathways at pressure points, not just in week 1.
- Frame help-seeking as part of learning, not evidence of failure.

EXAMPLE IN PRACTICE

At each major milestone the educator reminds students what support exists and what kind of issue each service can help with.

STARTING POINT TO ADAPT

In this course, we aim to normalise help-seeking and make support routes visible before students reach crisis point. If the way a class or learning activity is organised makes it harder for you to participate or understand…

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